



French 1

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADES 9–12 · FULL YEAR · 1 CREDIT

~4¼ hrs per week · 50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This page is drawn from the Florida course description rather than a built Optima course, so the specific units, materials, and activities scholars see will be set by the teacher and may vary between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

French 1 introduces scholars to the French language and the cultures of the French-speaking world. The course develops communication in all three modes — understanding, conversing, and presenting — with the emphasis on actually using the language. Reading and writing are introduced alongside listening and speaking, and culture runs through everything: greetings and celebrations, foods and traditions, and the contributions of French-speaking cultures to our global society. Scholars work through the Novice range, finishing the year able to handle short conversations and simple paragraphs on familiar topics.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 Listening (Novice)

Understanding everyday expressions, short conversations, songs, stories, and simple announcements on familiar topics.

3 Conversation (Novice)

Greetings and introductions, questions and answers about self, family, and preferences, and short social exchanges.

5 Writing (Novice)

Simple sentences about self and daily life, filling out forms, short personal notes, and drafting a trip itinerary.

2 Reading (Novice)

Familiar words and phrases, signs and notices, simple stories, and short messages supported by visuals.

4 Presenting (Novice)

Presenting personal information, daily activities, likes and dislikes, and role-playing skits, songs, and poems.

6 Culture and Connections (all year)

Practices, products, and perspectives of French-speaking cultures; cognates and comparisons with English; celebrations, music, food, and art.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Daily practice in the target language across listening, speaking, reading, and writing.
- New vocabulary and structures introduced in context, then used in short conversations and exchanges.
- Regular speaking and writing tasks: introductions, descriptions, skits, notes, and presentations.
- Culture woven through the week: songs, celebrations, images, and authentic materials from the French-speaking world.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes / week

≈ 50 minutes a day, Monday–Friday

- Daily lesson and practice fill most of the scheduled time.
- Speaking assessments and presentation weeks may run a little longer.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- Headphones and a microphone for listening and speaking practice.
- A notebook for vocabulary, structures, and culture notes.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily on the school's schedule.